

Lab 0: Environment Gate

Duration: 25 min (self-paced, complete BEFORE Day 1 Block 1 ends)

Difficulty: Setup

Deliverable: A machine that passes every check below and shows the marker **YOU ARE READY**.

Objective

Verify your seat license, install Claude Code with the native installer, and confirm your environment is green before the first lab. Nothing in Day 1 works until this does.

***START MARKER:** You have a terminal open and can type commands.*

Step 1: Identity and Access Check (5 min)

Claude Code access can come from an individual subscription, a Team or Enterprise seat, an Anthropic Console/API account, or an approved cloud provider. Team Standard and Premium seats can both carry Claude Code access; organization policy, allowances, and available models still vary.

1. Confirm the exact work email/identity approved for the course.
2. Sign in with that identity. Do not substitute a personal account.
3. Launch Claude Code. If access is denied, stop and contact the training coordinator with the exact error.
4. Once signed in, use `/usage` and `/model` to verify the live account rather than relying on a remembered pricing table.

Expected output marker: Claude Code opens under the approved identity and `/usage` returns account or provider information.

Step 2: Install Claude Code - Native Installer (10 min)

Claude Code no longer requires Node.js or npm. The npm install path was deprecated in January 2026. Use the native installer for your OS. Windows runs natively - no WSL required.

macOS / Linux:

```
curl -fsSL https://claude.ai/install.sh | bash
```

or Homebrew:

```
brew install --cask claude-code # or use the curl one-liner above
```

Windows (PowerShell):

```
winget install Anthropic.ClaudeCode
```

Windows (PowerShell one-liner, self-updating - preferred):

```
irm https://claude.ai/install.ps1 | iex
```

Linux package managers: `apt`, `dnf`, and `apk` packages are also available - see the install docs at code.claude.com.

Verify:

```
claude --version
```

Expected output marker: A current stable version, with **v2.1.219 or later** required for every model and orchestration feature taught in this course. Run `claude update` if needed. If you see `command not found`, close and reopen your terminal so PATH updates take effect.

Step 3: Git + VS Code Check (3 min)

```
git --version
```

Expected: `git version 2.x.x`

```
code --version
```

Expected: A VS Code version number. (VS Code is optional but recommended - the extension bundles the CLI. Terminal-only is fully supported.)

For the lab sample project only (not for Claude Code itself):

```
node -v
```

Expected: `v18.x` or higher. The Day 1 build project uses Node/Express. If Node is missing, install the LTS from nodejs.org.

Step 4: Create the Course Workspace (2 min)

The first hands-on lab creates the `business-dashboard` project from scratch, so no external sample repository is required.

```
mkdir claude-code-training
cd claude-code-training
git init
```

Expected output marker: Git reports an initialized repository in the empty course workspace.

Step 5: First Launch + /doctor Green (5 min)

```
claude
```

1. Complete the sign-in flow **with the identity from Step 1**.
2. When the prompt appears, run:

```
/doctor
```

Expected output marker: All checks green. The July 2026 `/doctor` runs a full diagnostic and can auto-fix common problems - if anything shows yellow/red, press `f` to auto-fix, then re-run `/doctor`.

3. Confirm the default model:

```
/model
```

Expected output marker: The organization-approved model appears. Sonnet 5 is the recommended daily model on the Anthropic API, but an administrator or provider may set a different default.

4. Exit for now:

```
exit
```

FINISH MARKER - YOU ARE READY

If every box below is checked, you are ready for Lab 1A:

- ☐ Approved identity launches Claude Code successfully
- ☐ `claude --version` returns v2.1.219+
- ☐ `git --version` works
- ☐ Node 18+ present (for the lab project)
- ☐ Empty course workspace initialized with git
- ☐ `/doctor` all green
- ☐ `/usage` and `/model` show the expected account/provider configuration

YOU ARE READY.

If Stuck

Problem	Recovery
<code>claude: command not found</code> after install	Close and reopen the terminal; on Windows, sign out/in or check PATH in System Settings
Sign-in loop / wrong account	Run <code>claude /logout</code> , then <code>claude</code> and use the Step 1 identity
<code>/doctor</code> shows red items	Press <code>f</code> for auto-fix; if still red, screenshot and post in the class channel
Corporate proxy blocks install	Ask IT to allow <code>claude.ai</code> and <code>code.claude.com</code> , or use the offline installer from your coordinator
Access denied or wrong organization	Capture the exact error and escalate to the coordinator; do not switch to a personal account

Debrief Questions

1. Which identity and provider path are you using, and who controls its policy and allowance?
2. Why does the native installer matter compared to the old npm path?
3. What does `/doctor`'s auto-fix (press `f`) actually change on your machine?